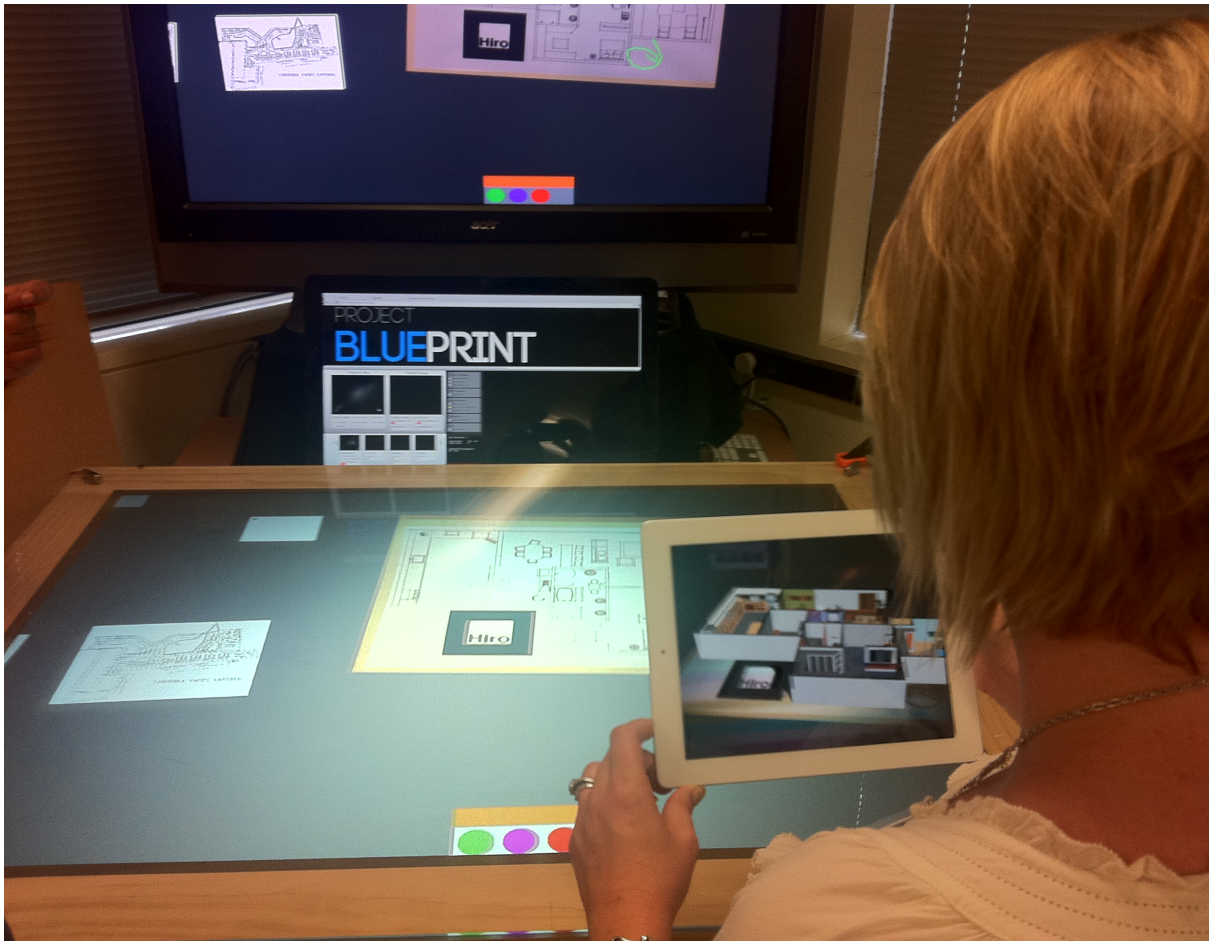
Project

An overview of your project



Project Blueprint https://flic.kr/p/azESZ5

Introduction

The main work you will carry out in *Design Computing Studio 3 - Proposal* is the completion of a project where your goal is to generate a set of needs or requirements for a system that addresses a problem, challenge, or design opportunity in the world. Projects will combine creative work where you generate multiple potential ideas with design research where you refine and develop ideas on the basis of information you gather about the problem domain or

context, and about the potential of your designs to produce solutions for stakeholders that are fit for purpose.

The outcome of your project this semester will be a proposed design for a digital system that a different team of students in the following semester will be able to take as their starting point to design and develop a working prototype in *Design Computing Studio 3 - Build*. The ability of students in teams to collaboratively produce a design that a different team can work from successfully, and for teams of students to be able to build a system based on a previous team's work are key learning outcomes in the two parts of Studio 3.

Task Description

There is a strong human-centred focus to the work you will need to carry out this semester. Technical solutions are rarely successful without being informed by a consideration of the needs and context of the people who will use or benefit from their creation. Across the whole project this semester, you will engage as a team in collaborative work to:

- Explore a context where you will design a digtital solution
- Generate ideas
- Justify design decisions on the basis of evidence gathered from user research, prior work, experimentation, and evaluation
- Adapt and develop your design in response to feedback and critique
- Communicate your work clearly in written and oral form

Required content

Each team is required to produce a design document, the *Proposal*, which is intended for use by a different team of students in the following semester. The Proposal should be created as the starting point for a later project that will design and build a prototype as described. The proposal document will need to clearly communicate **what** is being proposed, along with **why** it has been designed in a particular way.

The *Build* team will have further design work to undertake in order to resolve how the proposed design should be realised. They will need to be able to understand the purpose and intended use of your proposed system, but also your justification and reasoning for why it should be built in a certain way. Any non-trivial system will likely involve conflicting needs and requirements. Decisions must be made to find a compromise or to prioritise one perspective over another. If any of these decisions need to be revisited later, then the Build team will need to access your design work to understand the justification for your decisions and what evidence you gathered to support them.

There will be scope for you to include other supporting media in addition to the design document itself, such as your design sketches, data from user studies, video and audio media to illustrate the context of use, etc.

Checkpoints

The project will be delivered throughout regular studio participation during the semester and checked via three main project checkpoints. At each stage, you should consider the checkpoint as a snapshot of where your project has progressed to, and the main purpose of the formative assessment items is to capture this snapshot so that the teaching team can provide feedback. The three checkpoints are as follows.

2-1 Problem Identification

At this stage of the project, your team should have collaboratively discussed and explored a problem domain or challenge to focus on, and have an initial identification of the design direction you are taking. For this first project checkpoint, you need to communicate the context of the problem you have identified, and the current status of your team's exploration of the solution space.

Presentation in studio, week 5

Documentation submission: Monday March 25, 13:00 AEST

2-2 Interim Project Critique

The purpose of this assessment checkpoint is to provide an update on progress with your project since the Problem Identification presentation and report. This is a semi-formal review of project progress, with the main focus of the checkpoint on how well the team communicates the current status of their project in order to receive feedback on their work to date and planned work for the remainder of the semester.

Presentation in studio, week 8

Documentation submission: Monday April 22, 13:00 AEST

2-3 Exhibit

The exhibit is a public social event where teams can present and discuss their creative technical work, which has developed through the semester as a well-considered solution to a significant problem or challenge they have identified. The submitted documentation forms the primary piece of work for your project, providing a detailed description of project outcomes.

Exhibit in studio, week 13

Documentation submission: Monday June 3, 13:00 AEST

The importance of balance

Successful studio projects maintain a balance between a team's focus on the task content, and on the work required to be an effective team, and on individuals maintaining a balance between being a good team member and focusing on what they as individuals contribute to the team's work. The assessment in this studio has been designed to evaluate your work in these different technical/social and individual/team dimensions. Collaborating with your teammates on the project will not only generate good quality outcomes for the team, but in

doing this you will also make individual contributions that you can record and reflect on in your journal and portfolio. If you do not put any effort into participating in the team work of the studio, it is highly likely that you will not have sufficient individual contributions to write about for your individual assessment.

Version information

Version 1.0	14/03/2024	Document created based on revision of the project task sheet from 2023	S.Viller